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US GTM — Tokenized Collectibles

A bootstrapped launch around graded slabs: build audience and supply now, launch the escrow-protected marketplace at Corp B, then roll out the full suite wave-by-wave.

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Securities, money-transmission, and corporate-formation decisions must be reviewed by licensed counsel and a CPA before you act. Sections flagged “see counsel” are where this matters most.

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US Go-To-Market — the Tokenized Collectibles Wedge → Full-Suite Rollout

A bootstrapped, compliance-coupled launch plan: build audience and supply **now** around tokenized graded collectibles (the only thing that's marketable today), launch the escrow-protected marketplace the day **Corp B** unlocks it, then roll out the rest of the suite wave-by-wave as legal status lands.

How to read this. Companion to `LAUNCH-READINESS.md` (the gate scorecard), `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` (Corp A/B/C ramp), and `GO-LIVE-PLAN.md §7` / `PRODUCTION-STRATEGY.md §8` (which this builds on, not duplicates). Tags: **DO NOW**, **DEFER → Corp B/C**, **see counsel**.

Strategy, not legal or investment advice. Securities/MSB/marketing-claim calls go through the fintech + securities counsel named in `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` / `GO-LIVE-PLAN.md`. Every marketing claim must pass the §3 say/never-say gate before it ships.

1 1. The wedge thesis

Lead with one thing: a "graded slabs" marketplace — PSA/BGS/SGC/CGC-graded **sports cards and Pokémon / TCG** under a single brand. The PRD already picked this wedge ("collectibles have proven consumer pull"; `argus_prdv1/01`), and it's the **lowest-securities-risk** real-world asset (a whole graded card is a *good*, not an investment contract — see §3), which is exactly why it's the safe first surface.

The honest sequencing — the spine of this plan:

	Today (Phase A)	Launch (Corp B)
What's legal	Authentication, tokenization, non-custodial ownership, provenance	+ escrow-protected, fiat-friendly buying (the trust moat)
What we do	Build audience + supply (waitlist, content, founding sellers tokenize slabs as provenance — <i>no money moves</i>)	Transact — the real marketplace goes live
Marketing	Demand + supply priming; "own it, prove it's real"	Convert the primed waitlist; "buy with zero risk"

The escrow-protected purchase (`COLLECTIBLES_ESCROW_ENABLED`) is **prod-fatal pending Corp-B counsel + MSB** (`LAUNCH-READINESS.md` §3). So we **manufacture demand and lock up supply now** — all Phase-A safe, zero money movement — and flip the transactional marketplace on the day escrow is legal. A primed waitlist

- a seeded catalog = a launch, not a cold start.

Voice (PRD 01): outcomes, not infrastructure. *"Own a graded first-edition Charizard — and actually own it."* Marketplace, **not** an exchange. Never "investing app," never "crypto."

2 The value proposition — both sides of the marketplace

A two-sided market only works if both sides win. Map each claim to the real product.

2.1 To the consumer / buyer (the new + returning collector)

- **Authenticity, guaranteed.** Every listing is **grading-cert verified** (`CERT_VERIFY_PROVIDER`) and **AI pre-graded** (`sellerCollectibleService`) — the counterfeit and grading-scam problem that plagues eBay/Marketplace is designed out. *"If it's listed, it's real."*
- **You actually own it.** The token lives in your **non-custodial wallet** with **on-chain provenance** — not an account entry on someone's server. Portable, yours, verifiable.
- **Buy with zero risk (Corp B).** Escrow-protected purchase (`collectiblePurchaseService` : hold → ship → confirm → release) is the **chargeback substitute** an irreversible rail needs — funds release to the seller only when you confirm. *Scam protection without a credit-card middleman.*
- **Lower fees.** Far below **eBay (~13% all-in)** and **auction houses (~20%+ buyer's premium)** — more of the price goes to the card, not the platform.
- **Instant liquidity + discovery.** Resell in taps, not a 7-day auction; an **AI agent** helps you find, price, and track cards under scoped, revocable permission.
- **One app.** Your slabs sit **next to your dollars and other tokenized assets** — the advantage single-category players (Courtyard, Collector Crypt, PWCC Vault) structurally can't match.

2.2 To the collectible holder / seller (the slab owner)

- **Instant liquidity for a graded slab** — a global buyer pool on tap, not a consignment queue.

- **An authenticity/provenance premium** — a tokenized, cert-verified slab with on-chain history is worth more and sells faster than a photo on a forum.
- **Get paid, keep it** — **escrow** means no chargebacks, no "item not as described" reversals, no PayPal holds (Corp B). The buyer can't claw funds after you've shipped.
- **Keep more** — a take rate well under eBay/auction houses; price discovery instead of a lowball offer.
- **The physical stays safe** — vault-or-ship-on-sale via escrow; tokenize once, trade many times without the card moving each time.
- **Be early** — the **Founding Sellers** program (§4) gives the first holders catalog placement and status before the marketplace is public.

3 3. Compliance-coupled messaging guardrails (the say / never-say gate)

The wedge is safe **only if we keep the framing tight**. Graded cards are **goods**, not **securities** — *provided* we never fractionalize, never promise returns, and never market them as investments. That is the whole reason collectibles is the launch surface; cross the line and it becomes a securities offering (B5 collectibles memo, [LAUNCH-READINESS.md](#)). 🏠

✅ Say	❌ Never say
own, collect, authenticate, provenance, trade, true ownership	invest, investment, returns, ROI, appreciate, portfolio, yield
graded, cert-verified, escrow-protected, non-custodial	bank, banking, deposits, FDIC, account (the chartered terms)
marketplace, collection, liquidity	exchange, securities, shares, fractional (v1)
"own a piece of the hobby"	"your cards will go up in value" / price predictions

Every post, caption, creator brief, and landing-page line passes this gate before it ships. The Howey line is a **firing-offense rule** for anyone authoring marketing.

4. Phase 0 — build audience + supply NOW (guerrilla, zero money movement)

Everything here is **Phase-A safe**: no customer funds, no money movement, collectibles framed as goods. This is pure top-of-funnel + supply lock-up while the Corp-B gates close.

4.1 Demand engine (the hobby lives on video)

- **TikTok + YouTube Shorts** — "rip" culture. The hobby's center of gravity. Partner with rippers/ breakers; the shareable moment is "*pull* → *grade* → *tokenize* → *own it forever, provably real*."
- **Instagram Reels** — slab beauty shots, provenance reveals, the design-led brand aesthetic.
- **X** — **build-in-public** — the tech (non-custodial, provenance, agent discovery) for the crypto/AI-curious crossover audience; ship log + demos.
- **Reddit / Discord** — r/PokemonTCG, r/sportscards, r/PSAcard, grading Discords. **Value-first** participation (authentication tips, scam call-outs), never spam.
- **Invite-only waitlist + referral loop** — manufacture scarcity, control onboarding risk, and measure a referral coefficient. Founding-collector tiers by referral count.
- **Card-show circuit** — the cheapest high-intent in-person channel; a booth that *authenticates + tokenizes on the spot* (provenance only) turns attendees into founding sellers.

4.2 Supply moat (the harder, more important side)

- **"Founding Sellers / Holders" program**. Recruit slab owners to **authenticate + tokenize their inventory as provenance only** — cataloged, not yet for sale. **No money moves** → **fully Phase-A safe**. This seeds the catalog and a **supply advantage** competitors can't quickly copy, and gives sellers status + placement at launch. The catalog *is* the moat: marketplaces are won on supply.
- **Creator seeding** — give rippers/PSA influencers founding-seller status; their pulls become the launch catalog and their audiences become the waitlist.

4.3 Cadence, funnel, metrics

- **Weekly**: 3–5 TikTok/Shorts, 2–3 Reels, daily X presence + replies, ongoing community value posts, 1 long-form "how authentication/provenance works."
- **Funnel**: content → waitlist → referral → **founding-seller tokenization (supply)** → (at Corp B) **first buy/sell**.
- **Metrics that matter**: waitlist signups, **referral coefficient (K)**, **# slabs tokenized as provenance** (supply), creator-content reach/saves, Discord/community size. Optimize the loops, not vanity counts.

5 5. The launch moment (at Corp B) — the marketplace goes transactional

The day `COLLECTIBLES_ESCROW_ENABLED` clears counsel + MSB, the escrow-protected, fiat-friendly marketplace opens — and the primed waitlist + seeded catalog convert into a real launch:

- **Convert the waitlist** in invite waves (scarcity + onboarding-risk control).
- **The trust-moat campaign:** *cert-verified + AI-graded + escrow-protected + you-truly-own-it + zero counterfeit* — the single message no incumbent marketplace can claim all of.
- **Founding-seller drops** — the seeded catalog goes live first; founding sellers get launch-week spotlight.
- **Amplify:** Product Hunt, hobby-press + crypto/fintech-press PR, creator launch content, the card-show circuit now selling for real.
- **Launch-week mechanics:** limited drops, referral unlocks, a public "authenticity guarantee."

6 6. Full-suite rollout — sequenced to legal/compliance status

Each product's marketing wave is **gated on its compliance unlock** (the prod-fatal switches in `LAUNCH-READINESS.md` §3; the Corp A/B/C ramp in `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md`). Marketing a capability before its gate clears is how fintechs get a cease-and-desist — so the waves are strict.

Wave	Product	Compliance trigger (switch / phase)	The message	Pulls / cross-sell
0	Provenance + non-custodial wallet	Phase A (now)	"Own it. Prove it's real."	Collectors → waitlist + supply
1	Escrow-protected collectibles marketplace	Corp B · COLLECTIBLES_ESCROW_ENABLED 	"Buy with zero risk."	The launch; waitlist → buyers/sellers
2	USD cash balance + retention	Phase A→B (non-custodial USDC now; fiat at B)	"Your dollars live next to your cards."	Marketplace users → hold balances
3	Debit cards	Corp B · CARDS_ENABLED (BIN-sponsor + PCI) 	"Spend from your collection's value."	Holders → daily spend
4	Bank rails / ACH (deposit-withdraw)	Corp B · BANK_RAILS_ENABLED (BaaS + MSB) 	"Move real dollars in and out."	Everyone → primary-account behavior
5	FX / cross-border	Corp B/C · FX_*ENABLED (MT posture) 	"Buy from / sell to collectors worldwide."	Sellers → global liquidity
6	Argus Pay (stablecoin rail)	Corp B/C · ARGUS_PAY_ENABLED 	"Pay any merchant, agent-native."	Power users → payments
7	RWA: real estate / treasuries / equities	Corp B/C · EQUITIES_ENABLED + counsel/TA/ATS 	"Own everything else, same tap."	Broaden the marketplace surface
8	Starter (teen / family)	Corp B/C · TEEN_ENABLED (COPPA, custodial) 	"Start your kid's collection + savings."	Parents in the collector base

The throughline: collectibles is the **acquisition wedge**; the **wallet + USD balance is retention**; each later wave is a **cross-sell into a base that already trusts the brand** — and each only turns on when its license/partner exists. You market what's legal, in order.

7 7. Brand & positioning guardrails

- **Outcomes, not infrastructure** (PRD 01): "own a graded Charizard," not "HTS tokens on Hedera."
 - **Marketplace, not exchange.** No charts, no day-trading UX, no "buy low sell high."
 - **The anti-positioning** (PRD 01) is a marketing constraint: not an investing app, not a crypto exchange, no advice, no recommendations — *users browse and decide*. This is the compliance moat.
 - **Design-led** — the monochrome + jade "Quiet Premium" aesthetic as a recognizable signature against a loud, scammy category.
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8 8. Funnel & metrics across phases

Phase 0 (now): content → waitlist → referral(K) → founding-seller tokenizations (SUP
Launch (Corp B): waitlist → activation → first buy/sell → GMV → take-rate revenue
Retention: 30/90-day retention → USD-balance attach → cross-product attach (wave

The few numbers to watch by phase: **supply** (slabs tokenized) and **K** pre-launch; **activation + first-transaction conversion + GMV** at launch; **retention + attach rate** after. Keep it lean.

9. Risks & mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Incumbent copies the wedge (Robinhood/PayPal)	Win supply first (founding-seller moat); be tokenization-native + one-app, not bolt-on
Howey-reframe trap — community/creators call it "investing"	The §3 gate is a hard rule; brief every creator; correct "investment" language publicly
Supply cold-start	Founding-Sellers program + card-show on-the-spot tokenization <i>before</i> launch
Corp-B timing slip (escrow delayed)	The provenance + authentication product stays live as the bridge — audience keeps a reason to engage without money movement
Creator dependency	Diversify across rippers/sports/Pokémon + owned channels (waitlist, Discord, email)
Counterfeit / grading-fraud reputational hit	Cert-verify + AI-grade + escrow are the product; lead with the "authenticity guarantee"

10. The one-line strategy

Manufacture demand and lock up supply now around the one thing that's legal to market — authenticated, truly-owned graded slabs — then flip the escrow-protected marketplace on at Corp B and cross-sell the rest of the suite into a base that already trusts you, one compliance unlock at a time.

Companion documents: `LAUNCH-READINESS.md` (gate scorecard + the prod-fatal switches that gate each wave), `CORPORATE-STRUCTURE.md` (Corp A/B/C), `GO-LIVE-PLAN.md` §7 (guerrilla channels), `PRODUCTION-STRATEGY.md` §8 (positioning), `argus_prdv1/01`, `/05` (vision + marketplace).
Product surface: `sellerCollectibleService`, `collectiblePurchaseService`, `marketplaceService`, `collectiblesProvider`.